Bilal Pandor

Senior Software Engineer

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Profile

A polyglot software engineer with 5+ years experience in the industry, contributing expertise to diverse projects spanning multiple languages, technology stacks and development domains. Passionate about software craftsmanship, fostering positive teamwork and actively contributing to shaping the future of technology.

Working in agile teams, development experience has been across the technology stack. Substantial experience in back-end development, utilising functional java (Java17, Vert.x, RxJava) programming to develop and deploy AWS hosted RESTful microservices serving a broad user base reaching millions. Additional back-end experience building RESTful APIS utilising C# (.Net) hosted with Azure. Front end experience using javascript/typescript combined with modern web tools (React/Angular) in Node.js environments.

Hands-on knowledge of CI/CD, containerisation and orchestration tools (Jenkins/Gitlab, Docker, Kubernetes, ECS) to ship products to customers/clients continuously. Utilisation of appropriate cloud tools (AWS/Azure) and IaC tools (terraform) to automate, package, deliver and support products in production environments. Keen focus on software quality and maintainability using Test-Driven and Behaviour-Driven development to ensure robust codebases, minimise defects, and facilitate seamless collaboration among cross-functional teams.

Employment

Natwest - London, Bishopsgate ***May 2021 - Present***

mPlatform (Mobile Platform) Software Engineer (Back end) *- Key member of dev team responsible for developing and maintaining cloud hosted RESTful microservices serving 8m+ mobile app and online banking customers*

- Lead design and functional implementation of customer facing features, working with stakeholders across the business to align development efforts with strategic goals, enhance user experiences, and deliver solutions that meet both technical requirements and business objectives
- Implementation of robust functional spring based microservices (Vert.x, RxJava, Java 17) with emphasis on unit, integration, regression & contract testing (JUnit, Mockito, AssertJ, Cucumber, Wiremock etc)
- Develop with a DevOps mentality - using Docker/Kubernetes/EKS to develop and ship services, managing test/production environments, contribute to development of CI/CD pipelines and automation tools
- Consider performance constraints of services/pods using load testing (Scala/Gatling) and expected TPS to make informed decisions on caching strategies, database optimizations, and system architecture enhancements, ensuring scalable and responsive solutions in alignment with performance goals
- Investigate pilot & production bugs using logs/metrics/alarms and push patches to unblock customer journeys
- Coaching and mentoring new joiners and junior devs, fostering a collaborative learning environment, and providing guidance on best practices, coding standards, and project methodologies to contribute to the overall success of the team

BT - Adastral Park, Ipswich ***Oct 2019 - May 2021***

ESP (Emergency Services Platform) Software Engineer (Full Stack) *- Key member of team responsible for design and implementation of a next generation replacement of the UK's existing Emergency Services (999) platform*

- Manage and lead team implementing a Windows DLL orchestration layer (C#, .NetCore, Web APIs, SIP) together with a .Net MVVM front end application (C#, XAML, .NetFramework) to be used by 999 first responders
- Ensure projects adhere to high performance standards by implementing techniques such as multi-threading, optimising garbage collection, and employing inter-process communication through pipes, among other strategies
- Contribute to development of back-end RESTful API's (Java / Spring webflux) and SSE project (Apache Kafka) to serve the front end as well as managing and maintaining project CI/CD environment (managing VMs, pipelines)
- Manage project documentation, deadlines, and releases by collaborating closely with the Product Owner, QA team, and stakeholders, ensuring accuracy, relevance, and supporting effective decision-making throughout the project lifecycle

BT Research - Adastral Park, Ipswich ***Sep 2018 - Oct 2019***

ETU (Emerging Technology Unit) Software Engineer (Full Stack) *- Key member of dev team responsible for architecturally modernising and introducing front ends for internally developed projects, to be licensed to third parties*

- Work closely with AI researchers to convert legacy and existing Java applications into containerised back-end (Java/Kotlin) microservices backed by NoSQL (Mongo) databases
- Development of front end web interfaces (Javascript, Node.js, React/Angular) to integrate with new microservices
- Liaise with devOps team to manage containerisation and deployment of projects using kubernetes and docker
- Delivery of internal and external product demos/presentations, internal best practice training sessions (TDD, Git, CI/CD, Maven/Gradle usage) to the wider research department as well as delivery of presentations at external tech conferences (e.g Wired Smarter)

BT Research - Adastral Park, Ipswich ***Jun 2017 - Sep 2017***

Software Research Summer Intern *- Build MVPs for emerging technologies, improving the efficiency of BTs engineers*

- Develop MVP native cross platform mobile apps in Java & C# (Xamarin / CodenameOne) for engineering fleet
- Implementation of MVP Microsoft Hololens AR & voice based (Windows MR / MS Luis / IBM Watson) training application for next generation BT engineering fleet onboarding

Academic Qualifications/Training

BT Software Engineering Graduate Scheme	***2018 - 2020***
BSc Computing, University of Greenwich *(1:1)*	***2015 - 2018***
Oracle Mentorship Programme	***2016***
A Level: Geography (A), Psychology (B), English Literature (C)	**2012-2014**
GCSE: 10 A-B including Mathematics (A), English (A), Business Studies (A)	**2011**

Skills Summary

Technical

- Core understanding of programming concepts (Object Orientation, Functional / Reactive Programming)
- Proficient in multiple programming languages (Java, JavaScript, C#) and good experience with a range of others (Scala, Kotlin, Python, C++), with associated build tools (Maven, Gradle, npm, pip etc)
- Web development and database knowledge (SQL, Access, HTML, JavaScript, ASP.Net, Spring boot)
- Broad understanding of the development life-cycle (Agile, Scrum, XP etc) and associated tools (Jira, Git etc)
- Good understanding of and hands on experience with cloud providers (AWS, Azure)
- Experience with a range of IDE's & game engines (IntelliJ, Visual Studio, Android Studio, Unity)

Communication / Teamwork

- Experience working in dynamic teams, with internal and offshore team members, as well as external clients
- Coaching and mentoring junior team members, enabling them to flourish as engineers in their own right
- Managing sprints, retros and the overall agile process when assuming scrum master role
- Delivery of internal and external presentations to technical/non-technical audiences (demos, brown bags etc)

Organisational

- Experience using popular kanban tools (Jira) and popular documentation tools (Confluence)
- Experience managing project documentation and release notes, ensuring customers/clients are kept up to date with each release

Hobbies/interests

I am someone who is always eager to learn and is excited at the potential for growth. To fulfil those aims I enjoy travelling to explore new cultures and reading (history/philosophy). I have a passion for tech which dates back to my childhood, when my father brought home a beastly looking machine, our first computer. Since then my interest and passion has grown and I thoroughly enjoy writing and working with software and hardware, to the extent that I have multiple personal projects that I work on using a custom built gaming PC.